

Check Point Software Technologies Ltd.

Takeaways from Our Meeting with Management

We hosted a group meeting today with CEO Nadav Zafrir, CFO Roei Golan, and CRO Sherif Seddik - we walk through our takeaways on the 2H26 guide, GTM changes, appetite for M&A, and more below...

We hosted a meeting with Nadav Zafrir, Chief Executive Officer, Roei Golan, Chief Financial Officer, and Sherif Seddik, Chief Revenue Officer, at Check Point and came away with the following takeaways: (1) the 2H guide assumes the lower close rates in 1H continue in 2H and doesn't contemplate any more price increases, though CHKP is seeing stabilization in its GTM organization and could raise prices in 2H in response to higher memory costs - pipeline looks better in 4Q and includes some large, 8-figure deals; (2) we dove one level deeper into recent GTM changes with CRO Sherif Seddik and learned that 25-30% of customers saw a transition in their account manager in 1Q, which contributed to the disruption in 1H - looking forward, we estimate the ~300 planned sales hires (or 100-150 net new) could have about ~100 bps of impact to FY27 margins but we could hear more about this on next quarter's earnings call; (3) emerging products (email security, CTEM, AI security) are \$250M in ARR growing 40%+, maintenance revenue could decline in 2H26 before returning to growth in 1H27, and appetite for larger M&A remains healthy as CHKP builds up the emerging part of its portfolio.

- **A few points on 2H: (1) guide assumes softer close rates from 1H will continue in 2H though we're through most of the GTM disruption; (2) guide doesn't include future price increases, but CHKP could raise prices again in response to higher memory costs; (3) pipeline looks better in 4Q both in new firewall deals & emerging products, including some 8-figure deals; (4) AI Network Firewall is a higher priced attached subscription.**

Looking into 2H, CHKP expects 3Q to be the trough with improvement starting in 4Q, which is why it reiterated its FY26 revenue guide despite lower expectations for 3Q - zooming in, close rates were lower y/y in 1H26 as a result of the go-to-market disruption, and the 2H guide assumes similar close rates to what we saw in 1H. That said, CHKP expects to see stabilization in the go-to-market organization going forward, which is driving higher qualified pipeline and could drive an improvement in close rates later in the year. From a pricing perspective, CHKP did a 5% price increase on its firewall business at the beginning of January and another 5% price increase on some appliances in April. Looking forward, the 2H guide doesn't contemplate any additional price increases, but memory costs continue to rise, so we would not be surprised if CHKP did another price increase here in 2H26 which could also be a factor for 4Q. Lastly, pipeline looks better going into 4Q both compared to 1H26 and previous years, as the business is past most of the disruption from the GTM reorg, new subscription products like the AI Network Firewall could start to contribute, and emerging products like email

Company Update

CHKP	EQUAL WEIGHT
U.S. Software	POSITIVE
Price Target	USD 140.00
Price (31-Jul-26)	USD 127.13
Potential Upside/Downside	+10.1%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

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security, CTEM, and AI Security continue to see momentum - there are also a few large, 8-figure deals in the pipeline that could close in 4Q. Zooming out on AI Network Firewall, this is a higher priced subscription that attaches to the appliance and does not require a new box to purchase - we expect that at some point in 3Q, we could see more new boxes include a year trial of this subscription, which could then prompt renewals in future years.

- **Focus on GTM changes with CRO: (1) GTM reorg earlier this year impacted at least a quarter of accounts in 1Q, which drove the disruption we saw in 1H; (2) plans to hire ~300 quota bearing reps (of which 100-150 will be net new) which we estimate could have ~1 point of margin impact, though we could hear more about potential margin impact on the earnings call next quarter.** A key focus this year has been the go-to-market changes as CHKP did a GTM reorganization earlier this year and is now planning to hire ~300 quota bearing reps to the sales organization, which it announced on its earnings call last week - so we dove deeper into these changes with CRO Sherif Seddik at our meeting. First, the reorg CHKP did earlier in the year was substantial as 25-30% of customers were assigned a new account manager and 5-10% didn't have an account manager in place yet during 1Q, which is what drove the disruption and lower close rates in the last two quarters. Now that the business is largely through these changes, CHKP plans to hire ~300 quota bearing reps to the sales organization, of which 100-150 would be net-new as there will be some natural turnover in the sales force as CHKP focuses on selling its broader platform as opposed to just a firewall sale, which requires a different sales motion. Back-of-the-envelope, we estimate this sales hiring could add \$35-40M in incremental opex in FY27 which on a ~\$3B revenue base equates to ~1 point of margin, but we expect to hear more about the potential impact to margins on the earnings call next quarter.
- **Other tidbits: (1) email/CTEM/AI security are ~\$250M in ARR combined growing 40%+ (note this doesn't include SASE); (2) maintenance revenue could decline in 2H before returning to growth in 1H27 due to weaker product results expected through 3Q; (3) CHKP could consider larger M&A to build up its emerging solutions - areas of focus could be AI security, OT, and segmentation.** Outside of the firewall business, emerging products (email security, CTEM, and AI security) grew ARR by 40%+ and billings by 35% y/y in 2Q as demand continues to be healthy and AI security is small but seeing momentum - those three solutions combined are ~\$250M in ARR currently or ~10% of total revenue but growing faster than the overall business, so that mix could grow over time (we note this doesn't include contribution from SASE). Separately, maintenance revenue was down y/y and q/q in 2Q as about 15% of the maintenance revenue line comes from professional services, which correlates to implementations related to firewall refresh - with lower refresh, CHKP did not sell as much implementation services in the quarter. Looking forward, maintenance revenue could continue to decline in 2H as CHKP expects the challenges in its firewall business to continue in 3Q with a return to growth in 1H27 as the appliance business improves in 4Q and into FY27. Zooming out, the majority of revenue still comes from the network security business which has historically grown single digits, so in order to reaccelerate growth, we believe CHKP will need to do more meaningful M&A to build up its emerging business which is growing faster. Remember CHKP issued a \$1.75B convert at the end of 2025, which combined with its strong cash balance allows it to build this emerging business both organically and inorganically - we could see CHKP bolster existing areas like AI security and also add new areas like OT and network segmentation.

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Primary Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)

Check Point Software Technologies Ltd. (CHKP, 31-Jul-2026, USD 127.13), Equal Weight/Positive, CE/J

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Sprout Social, Inc. (SPT)	Tenable Holdings Inc (TENB)	Teradata Corp. (TDC)
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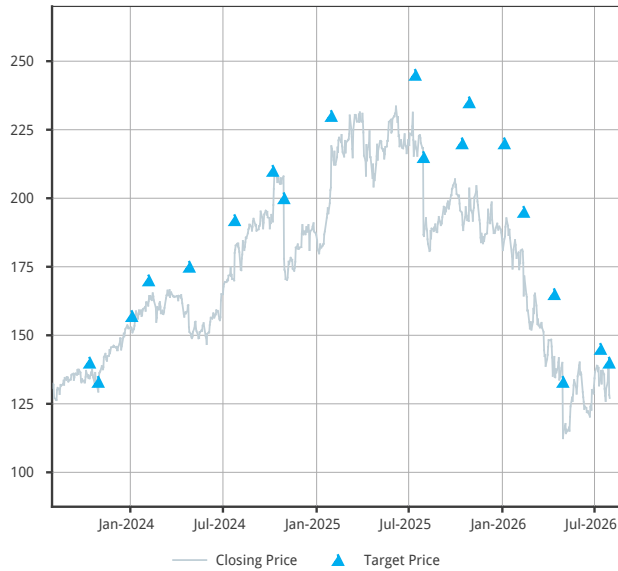
Check Point Software Technologies Ltd. (CHKP / CHKP)

Stock Rating: **EQUAL WEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 127.13** (31-Jul-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart (as of 31-Jul-2026)



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target	Currency
30-Jul-2026	139.67		140.00	USD
13-Jul-2026	131.70		145.00	USD
30-Apr-2026	139.96		133.00	USD
13-Apr-2026	135.22		165.00	USD
12-Feb-2026	176.47		195.00	USD
05-Jan-2026	181.03		220.00	USD
28-Oct-2025	191.72		235.00	USD
14-Oct-2025	194.85		220.00	USD
30-Jul-2025	218.33		215.00	USD
14-Jul-2025	221.26		245.00	USD
30-Jan-2025	203.90		230.00	USD
29-Oct-2024	207.96		200.00	USD
07-Oct-2024	193.93		210.00	USD
24-Jul-2024	170.00		192.00	USD
26-Apr-2024	161.00		175.00	USD
06-Feb-2024	160.80		170.00	USD
04-Jan-2024	152.82		157.00	USD
30-Oct-2023	131.84		133.00	USD
13-Oct-2023	134.37		140.00	USD

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